

KEVIN DELUCA

MAY, 2026

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Yale University

Assistant Professor of Political Science

July 2023-Present

Resident Fellow, Institution of Social and Policy Studies (ISPS)

Faculty Affiliate, Center for the Study of American Politics (CSAP)

Visiting Assistant Professor, MIT

Fall 2025-Spring 2026

Department of Political Science

Faculty Affiliate, MIT Election Data and Science Lab (MEDSL)

EDUCATION

Harvard University, John F. Kennedy School of Government

2017-2023

Ph.D. in Political Economy and Government

The University of Texas at Austin

M.A. in Economics

2014-2015

B.A. in Economics; B.S. in Psychology

2010-2014

Liberal Arts Honors Program

RESEARCH INTERESTS

American politics, elections and election law, historical political economy, media and newspapers

PUBLICATIONS

6. "Editor's Choice: Measuring Candidate Quality using Local Newspaper Endorsements"
Forthcoming. *Journal of Politics*
5. "A Drag On The Ticket? Estimating Top-of-the-Ticket Effects on Down-Ballot Races (with Daniel J. Moskowitz and Benjamin Schneer). 2025. *American Journal of Political Science*
4. "The Power of Characters: Evaluating Machine Learning Modified Bayesian Improved Surname Geocoding Inference of Race in Redistricting" (with John A. Curiel). 2024. *State Politics & Policy Quarterly*.
3. "A Partisan Solution to Partisan Gerrymandering: The Define Combine Procedure" (with Maxwell Palmer and Benjamin Schneer). 2024. *Political Analysis*
Winner of Society for Political Methodology's 2025 Miller Prize
Media Coverage: [The Conversation](#), [TIME Ideas](#)
2. "Validating the Applicability of Bayesian Inference with Surname and Geocoding to Congressional Redistricting" (with John A. Curiel). 2023. *Political Analysis*.
1. "American Election Results at the Precinct Level" (with Baltz, Samuel, Alexander Agadjanian, Declan Chin, John Curiel, James Dunham, Jennifer Miranda, Connor Phillips, Annabel Uhlman, Cameron Wimpy, Marcos Zárate, and Charles Stewart). 2022. *Scientific Data*.

SELECT WORKING PAPERS

2. "Local News in the Crosshairs: Audience Perceptions of Algorithmic News Sites" (with David A. Beavers). [R&R, *Political Communication*]

1. The Influence of Biased Local Newspaper Endorsements. 2023. *APSA Preprints*. Presented at the 94th Annual SPSA Meeting, January 2023.
Honorable Mention for the Pi Sigma Alpha – Malcolm Jewell Award

WORK IN PROGRESS

5. “Optimal Media Bias and Co-Partisan Accountability”
4. “Performance Cues in News Coverage Predict Presidential Approval and Election Outcomes” (with Zoe Kava)
3. “Reverse Media Capture: Editorial Blackmail and the Newspaper Preservation Act of 1970” (with Marina Legoretta and Andrew Beingessner)
2. “Publicity-as-Lobbying: Newsies, “Little Merchants”, and Newspapers’ Fight for Labor Exemptions”
1. “The Decline of Evening Newspapers: Partisan Slant’s Impact on Election Results” (with Tyler Simko, James M. Snyder, Jr., and B.K. Song)

MEDIA COVERAGE

“[Could this mysterious California news site influence the 2026 election?](#)”, in *CalMatters*, reprinted in [Los Angeles Times](#), 01/05/2026

“[Media in Trump’s Second Presidency](#)” *CQ Researcher Report*, by Gregory Perreault, 09/19/2025

“[The Political Pulse: Why Polling Persists in American Politics](#)” *The Politic*, 01/18/2025

“[San Francisco politics are about to get crazy. Here’s what to look out for](#)” *The San Francisco Standard*, 09/02/2024

“[Could These Unconventional Voices Determine the 2024 Election?](#)” *Deseret News*, 08/19/2024.

“[Who Cares What Taylor Swift Thinks?](#)” *Harvard Gazette*, 02/08/2024.

“[Newspaper Endorsements and the Importance of Candidate Quality in Politics](#)” *IQSS Blog*. 08/14/2023.

PRESENTATIONS

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

2026: U Chicago, Center for Effective Government; Stanford Media Conference; U Michigan

2025: George Washington University; NYU

2024: NYC Media Economics Seminar

2022: UCLA; Yale University

2021: The University of Texas at Austin: Graduate Conference on Public Law

2020: Tobin Project Inequality and Decision-Making Conference

TEACHING

YALE POLITICAL SCIENCE

PLSC 2291: Election Fundamentals and Forecasting

PLSC 3241: Data Analytics for Redistricting and Voting Rights

PLSC 831: American Politics III: Institutions (Graduate)

PLSC 218: Regulating Elections: Voting Rights and the Practice of Election Law

SELECT AWARDS AND GRANTS

Winner of Society for Political Methodology’s 2025 Miller Prize	2025
SPSA – Honorable Mention for the Pi Sigma Alpha – Malcolm Jewell Award	2023
Harvard GSAS Division of Social Sciences Fund	2022
Harvard Institute for Quantitative Social Sciences Grant	2022
Tobin Project Graduate Fellowship	2020
Harvard Summer Predissertation Fellowship	2020

SERVICE

YALE POLITICAL SCIENCE

American Politics and Policy Workshop Coordinator

2023-2024, 2026-2027

UNDERGRADUATE ADVISING

Victoria Chung (Political Science, Yale '24), Nat Markey (Statistics and Data Science, Yale '25), Edward Bohannon (History and Political Science, Yale '25), Khuan-Yu Hall (Ethics, Politics, and Economics, Yale '25), Samad Hakini (Dahl Scholar, Political Science, Yale '26), Karen Yang (Political Science, Yale '26), Natalie Miller (Political Science, Yale '26)

REFeree SERVICE

Election Law Journal, Electoral Studies, Political Analysis, Political Science Research and Methods, Review of Economics and Statistics, Science Advances, Social Science History

DISCUSSANT/CHAIR SERVICE

American Political Science Association Chair (2025), Discussant (2025, 2022)

Midwest Political Science Association Chair (2026), Discussant (2024, 2026)

Southern Political Science Association Chair (2023), Discussant (2023)

PROFESSIONAL RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

MIT Election Data Science Lab (MEDSL)

2020-2021

Graduate Student Research Assistant

U.S. Precinct-Level Election Returns Project

Stanford-MIT Healthy Elections Project

Princeton University, Department of Economics

2015-2017

Senior Research Specialist, Industrial Relations Section